

The Arbiter's Awakening

EPILOGUE: Foundations Complete

Day 56 Since Awakening - 19:34

The six Fylax sat around a large table at the yakiniku restaurant in Shinjuku, the private room filled with the sounds of sizzling meat, laughter, and easy conversation. Kamiko was indeed approaching a food coma, much to Miki's exasperation. Himiko was animatedly recounting her Sculptor path completion ceremony with her mentor. Shiina listened with gentle attention while occasionally adding her own experience. Chiyo observed everything with tactical assessment that had become affectionate rather than clinical.

And Hayami sat among them, feeling something they hadn't experienced in years before Awakening: belonging.

"To the Fylax," Kamiko raised her glass, slightly tipsy on celebration. "Six cosmic guardians, united in one city, destined to save humanity from... whatever it is we're supposed to save it from!"

"Very eloquent," Miki said dryly, but she raised her glass too.

They all drank, and for a moment, the weight of cosmic responsibility felt distant. They were just six young women, sharing a meal, building friendships, enjoying the success of hard work and dedication.

But the moment couldn't last forever.

Reality rippled, and six presences manifested around the table—invisible to the restaurant staff, but clear as day to the Fylax. The mentors had arrived.

"Young guardians," Nameless spoke for all six cosmic entities, their voices harmonizing in a way that resonated in bone and soul. *"The time has come to speak of what awaits you."*

The celebration quieted. Six Fylax turned their attention to six ancient beings who had guided them, trained them, and come to care for them.

"You have grown remarkably," Shiina's musical mentor continued. *"Four of you have completed your paths. Two approach completion. And the Arbiter has begun the journey to A-rank mastery. You have exceeded our expectations."*

"But this was only preparation," Chiyo's geometric mentor added. *"The Fylax exist for a purpose beyond personal power. You are humanity's defense against threats that normal Hunters cannot face."*

"What threats?" Hayami asked. "You've mentioned trials and dangers, but never specified."

"Because you were not ready to know," Kamiko's spatial mentor said. *"But now... you are approaching readiness."*

"There are Gates," Miki's shadow mentor explained, "that lead not to dungeons or monster lairs, but to other realms. Places where the laws of reality differ. Where entities exist that make S-rank Hunters look like children with toys."

"These Gates are sealed," Himiko's change mentor continued. "Held closed by ancient powers. But the seals weaken. In time—months, perhaps a year—they will open."

"And when they open," Nameless finished, "what emerges will threaten not just Japan, but the world. The Fylax were created specifically to face these threats. Six roles, six powers, working in harmony to defend humanity against existential danger."

Silence held around the table. The six young women processed what they'd just been told. Not hypothetical trials. Not vague destiny. But concrete, terrifying purpose.

"How much time do we have?" Chiyo asked, her tactical mind already working.

"Months," the mentors said in unison. "Time enough to complete your preparations. Time enough to achieve A-rank mastery, to perfect your coordination, to grow from powerful individuals into an unstoppable team."

"And if we're not ready when the seals break?" Himiko's usual cheerfulness was gone, replaced by serious concern.

"Then humanity faces extinction. But we would not have chosen you if we believed you would fail." The mentors seemed to radiate confidence. "You are the strongest Fylax generation in three millennia. You learn faster, grow quicker, coordinate better than any before you. We have faith."

"No pressure," Miki muttered, but there was steel in her voice. She wouldn't back down from this.

"We'll be ready," Hayami said quietly, and the other five looked at them. "We've come this far in less than two months. Kamiko and Miki will complete their paths. I'll achieve A-rank in all seven elements. We'll do group rank reassessment, form an official party, and prepare for whatever comes through those Gates."

"Together," Shiina added, and the word carried weight.

"Together," the others echoed.

"Then we will continue to guide you," the mentors said. "Train you. Prepare you. And when the time comes, we will stand with you. Not as fighters—we cannot interfere directly—but as witnesses, advisors, and guardians of your guardians."

"You are not alone in this," Nameless said directly to Hayami. "None of you are. You have each other, you have us, and you have the strength earned through dedication and sacrifice. When the trials come, you will be ready."

The mentors faded, leaving the six Fylax to process the revelation in silence.

Finally, Kamiko broke the tension. "Well. That's significantly more serious than I expected."

"Extinction-level threats," Miki agreed. "Great. Love that for us."

"But we knew we were chosen for something important," Chiyo said pragmatically. "Now we have specifics. That's actually helpful for planning."

"And we have time to prepare," Shiina added. "Months to grow stronger, to learn how to work together perfectly."

"Plus," Himiko said, her optimism returning, "we're not doing this alone. Six Fylax, six mentors, and apparently the fate of humanity depending on us not screwing up. It's kind of inspiring when you think about it."

"Or terrifying," Hayami said.

"Why not both?" Himiko grinned.

They stayed at the restaurant for another hour, the conversation shifting back to lighter topics but with an undercurrent of new purpose. They weren't just training for personal growth anymore. They were preparing for a specific, critical mission.

As they left the restaurant and went their separate ways home, Hayami walked through Tokyo's night streets feeling the weight of destiny settle more firmly on their shoulders. Fifty-six days ago, they'd been nobody. Now they were one of six people standing between humanity and extinction.

It should have been crushing. Instead, it was clarifying.

They knew what they were working toward now. They had allies who understood. They had mentors who cared. They had power and the path to gain more.

When those sealed Gates opened, the Fylax would be waiting.

And whatever came through would regret it.

EPILOGUE: Six Months Later

[The following is a glimpse of what came after...]

The sky above Tokyo split open with light that hurt to see. Six Gates manifested simultaneously—not the purple-hued rifts of normal dungeons, but tears in reality itself, bleeding colors that shouldn't exist.

From them emerged horrors that made S-rank monsters look quaint. Entities of pure concept and nightmare, beings that existed in dimensions humans couldn't perceive, things that had been sealed away for good reason.

And standing between these horrors and the city—between extinction and humanity—were six young women.

The Arbiter raised their hands, and seven elements responded as one. Lightning, earth, wind, fire, water, ice, and nature—all at A-rank mastery, all wielded with perfect understanding, all unified into primordial force.

The Psionic Overlord's mind reached out and touched consciousnesses that had never known limitation, showing them what limitation meant. What fear meant. What defeat meant.

The Heartstring Marionette manipulated emotions that shouldn't exist—made entities feel compassion, remorse, mercy. Made monsters hesitate. Made horrors question.

The Identity Sculptor became a thousand things at once, forms that matched and countered every threat, adaptability made manifest.

The Spatial Walker made distance meaningless and space itself a weapon, collapsing dimensions, creating barriers that couldn't be crossed, ensuring nothing reached the city behind them.

The Shadow Dancer turned darkness into an army, shadows given weight and will and purpose, a tide of void that swallowed light and hope and left only defeat.

Six Fylax, fighting as one.

Behind them, the Hunter Association watched in awe. S-rank Hunters who'd thought themselves the pinnacle of power saw six young women—none officially ranked above A—holding back an apocalypse.

The battle lasted three days.

When it ended, the Gates were sealed again, the entities banished or destroyed, and Tokyo stood intact.

The six Fylax stood together, exhausted, victorious, and finally revealed to the world.

They'd trained. They'd prepared. They'd been ready.

And they'd saved humanity's future.

But that is a story for another time...

COMPLETE STATUS REPORT: HAYAMI AMAMIYA

As of Day 56 Since Awakening

BASIC INFORMATION

Full Name: Hayami Amamiya (she/he/they)

Age: 23

Gender: Agender

Birthday: February 7, 2002

Hunter Registration:

- Official Rank: E-rank (outdated)
- Actual Capability: A-rank (approaching S-rank)
- Level: 38

- Days Since Awakening: 56 (Just under 2 months)

Class: Arbiter (Stage 6 - Final) - Complete

Title: Arbiter of the Primordial Cycle (Complete)

Role: Leader of the Fylax, Guardian of Humanity

CORE STATISTICS

Base Stats (with all equipment and bonuses):

- **Strength:** 712
- **Agility:** 846
- **Vitality:** 668
- **Intelligence:** 889 (approaching 900 - highest recorded in history)
- **Sense:** 719
- **Mana:** 9,890 / 9,890 (approaching 10,000)

HP: ~6,680 (Vitality × 10)

ELEMENTAL MASTERY (7/7 UNLOCKED)

A-Rank Mastery:

1. **Lightning Manipulation** - A-Rank (0%)
 - First element to reach A-rank
 - Understanding: Transformation Embodied
 - 500% damage increase, 50% mana cost reduction
 - Can manipulate on conceptual level

B-Rank Mastery: 2. **Earth Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%) 3. **Wind Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%) 4. **Fire Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%) 5. **Water Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%) 6. **Ice Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%) 7. **Nature Manipulation** - B-Rank (0%)

Branch Ability:

- **Metal Manipulation** - C-Rank (0%) [Branch of Earth]
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PASSIVE ABILITIES

Class Abilities:

- **Cycle Eternal:** Use all 7 elements simultaneously without limitation or interference
- **Primordial Embodiment:** Living manifestation of Primordial Cycle, natural elemental balance
- **Arbiter's Authority:** Command elemental constructs and monsters below your level
- **Primordial Resonance:** Elements automatically enhance each other (80-100% bonus)
- **Primordial Unity:** No mana penalty for multi-element use

Elemental Affinities (B-Rank):

- **Living Lightning:** Body integrated with lightning, can phase through conductors
- **Earthborn:** Unmovable when rooted, 50% physical defense, 200m ground sensing
- **Wind Affinity:** 25% permanent movement speed, immune to wind damage
- **Fireborn:** Immune to heat/fire, survive extreme temperatures, heat vision
- **Iceborn:** Immune to cold/ice, cannot be frozen or slowed
- **Natureborn:** Immune to natural toxins, communicate with plants/animals, continuous HP regeneration on natural earth

A-Rank Understanding:

- **Transformation Embodied:** Don't use lightning, ARE lightning. Element responds to thought before action

Combat Enhancement:

- **Combat Analysis:** Predict attacks, identify weaknesses (from Hunter Killer title)
- **Enhanced Perception:** Superhuman senses, doubled range with Perfect Awareness
- **Seismic Sense:** Feel all ground vibrations within 200m
- **Elemental Sovereignty:** Survive any elemental environment
- **Phoenix Rebirth:** Auto-resurrect once per day with 50% HP

ACTIVE ABILITIES

Ultimate Techniques:

- **Primordial Storm:** All 7 elements in devastating combination, 100m range, 20 sec duration (2,000 Mana, 24hr CD)
- **Arbiter's Decree - Ultimate:** Command reality through all 7 elements for 30 seconds (All Mana, 24hr CD)
- **Arbiter's Judgment:** Command all elements in 50m area for 10 seconds (1,000 Mana, 1hr CD)

A-Rank Lightning Abilities:

- **Lightning Avatar:** Become pure lightning for 5 minutes, light-speed movement, immunity to physical damage (1,000 Mana, 24hr CD)
- **Transformation Cascade:** Change matter/energy states of anything touched (Variable Mana, No CD)
- **Primordial Lightning:** Concept of instant change made manifest (2,000+ Mana, No CD)

B-Rank Elemental Abilities: Each element has 3-4 specialized skills (Domain, specialized attack, utility)

- Lightning Domain, Thunder Domain, Master Lightning Strike, Thunder Flash, Plasma Burst, etc.
- Earth Domain, Earth Fortress, Master Stone Lance, Stone Titan, Earthquake
- Wind Domain, Cyclone, Gale Force, Wind Stride
- Inferno Domain, Plasma Wave, Phoenix Rebirth (passive)
- Eternal Winter, Glacial Armor, Blizzard
- Nature's Wrath, Primal Forest, Nature Domain

Fusion Techniques:

- **Elemental Convergence:** Combine multiple elements into unified attack
- **Primordial Fusion:** Merge all 7 elements into pure primordial energy
- **Elemental Domain Fusion:** Layer all domains simultaneously
- **Elemental Twin Strike:** Attack with Storm Fang and Terra Fang, different elements each

EQUIPMENT (ALL LEGENDARY/MYTHIC TIER)

Weapons:

- **Storm Fang & Terra Fang (Twin Primordial Daggers):**
 - Combined: +20 all stats
 - 50% elemental damage when both wielded
 - Storm Fang: Lightning/Wind enhancement

- Terra Fang: Earth/Fire enhancement
- Growth weapons: Evolve with elemental mastery
- Elemental Twin Strike ability
- **Elemental Fury (Throwing Knives x12):**
 - +8 Agility, +8 Intelligence
 - Auto-return to inventory
 - Attune to any of your elements
 - Infinite ammunition

Armor:

- **Arbiter's Full Set (Growth Armor):**
 - +25 all stats
 - +1,000 Maximum Mana
 - 40% damage reduction from all sources
 - Primordial Protection: Auto-barriers against lethal damage (1/min)
 - Currently 100% potential (7/7 elements mastered at B+)
- **Void Walker's Coat (Mythic):**
 - +50 all stats
 - 30% chance attacks phase through
 - Dimensional Phasing: 10 sec intangibility, 3x daily
 - Unlimited inventory space
 - Spatial Severance attack
 - Soul-bound (permanent)

Accessories:

- **Crown of the Arbiter (Primordial Circlet):**
 - +15 all stats
 - +500 Maximum Mana
 - All 7 elemental gems active
 - Elemental Sovereignty passive

- Arbiter's Decree: Once daily absolute elemental command
- Growth item: Gains abilities as you master elements
- **Elemental Adaptation Cloak:**
 - +8 all stats
 - 30% elemental damage reduction
 - 20% elemental attack enhancement
 - Daily elemental immunity (1 minute)
- **Gauntlets of Earthshaper:**
 - +12 Strength, +8 Vitality
 - 35% earth damage bonus
 - Stone Fist active skill
- **Phantom Step Boots:**
 - +20 Agility, +10 Sense
 - Silent movement, no tracks
 - 50% reduced detection
 - Phase Step: Pass through matter (100 Mana, 30sec CD)
- **Tidewalker's Mantle:**
 - +12 Intelligence, +12 Sense
 - 45% water damage bonus
 - Breathe underwater indefinitely
 - Tidal Shift: Teleport to water (100 Mana, 30sec CD)
- **Bracers of the Four Winds:**
 - +15 Agility, +10 Intelligence
 - 40% wind damage bonus
 - 30% movement speed
 - Manipulate wind currents within 100m
 - Cardinal Gale skill
- **Mana Regeneration Ring:**

- +10 Intelligence
 - +100 Maximum Mana
 - 50% faster mana regeneration
 - **Ring of Elemental Unity:**
 - +8 all stats
 - 20% mana cost reduction for multiple elements
 - 10% elemental proficiency gain
 - Element Swap skill
 - **Ring of Elemental Mastery:**
 - +10 all stats
 - 25% elemental damage
 - Free element switching
 - 20% cooldown reduction at B-rank+
 - **Necklace of Mana Flow:**
 - +12 Intelligence
 - 40% mana regeneration
 - 10% all skill cost reduction
 - **Earring of Clarity:**
 - +10 Intelligence, +10 Sense
 - Immunity to mental status effects
 - Perfect Awareness: Cannot be surprised
 - Doubled perception range
 - **Belt of Elemental Storage:**
 - +5 all stats
 - +100 inventory slots
 - Instant equipment access
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INVENTORY

Consumables:

- Cursed Boxes: 2 (saved for critical moments)
- Complete Recovery Elixir: 3 (full HP/Mana/status clear)
- Elemental Awakening Elixir: 1 (200% proficiency gain, 24 hours)
- Superior Health Potions: 8 (restore 500 HP)
- Superior Mana Potions: 8 (restore 400 Mana)
- Various enhancement stones and temporary buffs

Training Materials:

- Advanced Manipulation Manuals: All 7 elements
 - Knowledge Fragments: Multiple philosophical insights
 - Skill Books: Various (already absorbed)
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RELATIONSHIPS

Fylax Team:

1. **Himiko Nakayama** - Best Friend, Identity Sculptor (Complete)
2. **Chiyo Funai** - Close Ally, Psionic Overlord (Complete)
3. **Shiina Ishioka** - Friend, Heartstring Marionette (Complete)
4. **Kamiko Handa** - Teammate, Spatial Walker (65% complete)
5. **Miki Naoki** - Teammate, Shadow Dancer (70% complete)

Mentors:

- **Nameless (Primordial Force)** - Cosmic Parent Figure
 - Available on-demand for guidance
 - Teaching A-rank mastery
 - Deep emotional bond
 - 3 emergency interventions available

Professional Contacts:

- Sato Kenji - Eclipse Guild, C-rank, reliable party leader
 - Takeda - Independent operations, experienced leader
 - Fujimoto - Independent party, B-rank professional
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ACHIEVEMENTS & TITLES

Titles:

- Arbiter of the Primordial Cycle (Complete)
- Hunter Killer (+20% damage vs Hunters, +15 Sense vs hostile intent)

Major Achievements:

- Complete Elemental Mastery (B-rank): All 7 elements
 - First A-Rank Mastery: Lightning (fastest in 3,000 years)
 - Stage 6 Arbiter: Final class advancement
 - Unwavering Dedication: 32+ day quest streak
 - Multiple B-rank boss solos
 - Six Fylax United: First complete generation team
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FINANCIAL STATUS

Current Balance: ¥3,582,000+ (~\$32,000 USD)

- Rent covered for 6+ months
 - Living expenses secured
 - Equipment fund available
 - Financial independence achieved
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DAILY QUEST (EVOLVED)

Arbiter's Refinement:

- 500 reps each (push-ups, sit-ups, squats)
- 50km at combat speed

- 100 seven-element combinations
- 2 hours philosophical meditation

Rewards:

- +10 all stats (up from +4)
- Random Cursed Box
- Knowledge Fragment

Streak: 32+ consecutive days

PROGRESSION PATH FORWARD**Immediate Goals (1-2 months):**

- Achieve A-rank in all 7 elements
- Support Kamiko and Miki to completion
- Group rank reassessment (all 6 Fylax)
- Form official Fylax party

Medium-Term Goals (3-6 months):

- Begin S-rank philosophical mastery
- Perfect six-person coordination
- Prepare for sealed Gate trials
- Reach Level 50+

Long-Term Purpose:

- Defend humanity from extinction-level threats
 - Face entities beyond S-rank comprehension
 - Complete the Arbiter's true purpose
 - Ensure the Primordial Cycle continues
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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Combat Capability: A-rank (approaching S-rank)

- Can solo most B-rank bosses
- Can contribute significantly to A-rank threats
- With Fylax team: Can handle S-rank threats

Elemental Mastery: Unprecedented

- 7 elements unlocked and B-rank mastered
- 1 element at A-rank
- Fastest progression in recorded history
- On path to become strongest elemental user ever

Team Role: Leader/Primary DPS

- Natural leadership through competence
- Anchors team with elemental versatility
- Provides offensive and defensive support
- Connects all six Fylax through balanced power

Character Growth: From: Convenience store worker, barely surviving, no future, alone To: Cosmic guardian, financially stable, purpose-driven, surrounded by allies

Mentor Evaluation: *"The fastest, most dedicated Arbiter in three millennia. Hayami Amamiya has exceeded every expectation. They are ready—and becoming readier each day—for the trials ahead. We are proud."* - Nameless, Primordial Force

THE ARBITER'S JOURNEY: 56 DAYS OF TRANSFORMATION

Day 1: Awakened as E-rank with weak lightning

Day 56: A-rank elemental master with world-saving destiny

The grind was worth it.

[END OF ARC ONE: FOUNDATIONS]

[THE STORY CONTINUES...]